

Transportation, Community, and System Preservation Program (TCSP)

PROGRAM FY 2012 GRANT APPLICATION
PART A. PROJECT INFORMATION

Project Title:	Ohio River Bike/Ped Trail, Phase I
Project Location (Include City/County, State):	Coraopolis Borough and Moon Township, in Allegheny County, PA. Trail generally follows State Route 51, with southern endpoint at Coraopolis at the Montour Trail near the Neville Island Bridge, and the northern endpoint at Moon Township at the Sewickley Bridge.
State Priority (to be completed by State DOT):DDOT	
GRANTEE CONTACT INFORMATION	
Grantee Contact Name:	Ray McCutcheon
Agency/Tribal Government:	Borough of Coraopolis
Mailing Address (Street/P.O. Box):	1012 5th Avenue
City, State, Zip code:	Coraopolis, PA 15108
Phone:	412.264.3002
Fax:	412.264.6951
E-Mail:	Manager@CoraopolisPA.com
STATE DOT CONTACT INFORMATION	
State Contact Person:	Gene Heyman, Transportation Planning Specialist, Center for Program Development and Management, PennDOT
Phone:	717-346-8133
Fax:	717-787-5247
E-Mail:	Gene Heyman <euheyman@pa.gov>
Additional Emails :	Casey Markey <cmarkey@pa.gov>, Kristin Mulkerin <kmulkerin@pa.gov>
FHWA DIVISION OFFICE CONTACT INFORMATION	
Division Contact Person:	Matt Smoker, Lead Program Development Specialist – Planning, US DOT / FHWA - PA Division
Phone:	717- 221-3703
Fax:	717-221-3709

E-Mail:	Matt.Smoker@dot.gov, Kathy.Dimpsey@dot.gov			
CONGRESSIONAL INFORMATION				
Congress Member:	Michael Doyle, Jr. (14); Tim Murphy (18)			
Congressional District No.:	14, 18			
TCSP Program Funds:	\$200,000.00			
Matching Funds/In-kind Services Value:	\$50,000.00 expected			
Matching Funds/In-kind Services Source:	State and County cash match expected, Local in-kind and cash match expected			
Total TCSP-Related Project Costs:	\$250,000.00			
TO BE COMPLETED BY THE FHWA DIVISION OFFICE				
State Administered?		Yes		No
Division Administered?		Yes		No
"Transfer" TCSP funding for Project Administration?		Yes		No
If yes, which Federal Agency				
Will the project be obligated by September 30, 2012?		Yes		No
Date grant application approved by FHWA Division Office				

Part B. Project Abstract

(Maximum 4 sentences) Briefly describe the how the TCSP Program funds will be used to support the proposed project.

Funding will be utilized to hire a consultant to prepare engineering, specifications, bid documents and to obtain required permits to construct an approximately 2.5 mile segment of the Ohio River Trail between Coraopolis Borough and Moon Township, Allegheny County, PA; connecting 2 brownfield reclamation sites, one of which was the focus of a U.S. EPA funded Partnership for Sustainable Communities Area-Wide Brownfields Planning Project for Coraopolis, and another brownfield-turned Waterfront-Park in Moon Township (see attached maps for project location and alignment).

The project has been identified through a Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources grant funded Feasibility Study as part of a 30+ mile bicycle/pedestrian trail along the Ohio River, closely paralleling PA Route 51 (a major north/south highway and PennDOT Designated PA Bicycle Route A) to the Ohio/Pennsylvania State Line.

This key project within the overall Ohio River Trail Corridor consists of off-road and on-road bicycle and pedestrian facilities linking the existing 46-mile Montour Trail to the Ohio River,

through a pending 78 acre Allegheny County Sport and Athletic Complex located on a former railyard, through the downtown Coraopolis commercial corridor, to a proposed transit center through to a planned Ohio River Waterfront park and the Sewickley Bridge in Moon Township.

The project has been identified to specifically improve the efficiency of the existing transportation system incorporating PennDOT Designated PA Bicycle Route A; enhance multi-modal choices including bike/ped and support transit access; support private sector reinvestment and development patterns and create a cohesive green corridor along existing PA Route 51.

Part C. Project Narrative -Describe the project and the expected results, including project goals and timeframe. The “**Ohio River Trail – Phase I**” project goal is to prepare design and engineering drawings, specifications, bid documents and obtain required permits to construct an approximately 2.5 mile segment of the Ohio River Trail, located on the South Shore of the Ohio River. **Timeframe:** Once funds are in place, and contract let, it will take one year to complete the project, with expected completion date of January 2014. Once this Phase is completed, additional funds will be sought to construct the multi-modal bike/ped trail and public access to and along the Ohio River. The project includes segments 500 and all of 600 in Coraopolis and Moon Township, as identified in the Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources (PA-DCNR) funded Ohio River Trail (ORT) South Shore Trail Feasibility Study ([see attached maps](#)). Moon Township and Coraopolis are part of the Pittsburgh MSA. This project helps to develop a linking system of safe and aesthetic walkable and bikeable communities.

The proposed project consists of transportation improvements that will form a continuous **urban multi-modal route/trail**. The route of the improvements will travel through Coraopolis from Moon Township’s Ohio River Waterfront Park and then via a utility corridor to Moon Township/Coraopolis Municipal Line near Thorn Run Creek. It will then travel via several roadways or rights-of-way, ultimately to the Allegheny Co. Sports Complex and the Montour Trail. The proposed multi-modal trail is a combination of a multi-use trail, signed on-road route, sharrows and green alleys. The transportation improvements directly serve two site-specific reuse areas in Coraopolis included in the **U.S. EPA funded Partnership for Sustainable Communities Area-Wide Brownfields Planning Project**.

1.) *Describe how the project integrates transportation, community, and system preservation plans and practices that address one or more of the following: Improve the efficiency of the transportation system of the United States.* **The Ohio River Trail Project Promotes Connections to Sustainable Transportation Investments.** The proposed project parallels and crosses PA Route 51 (PennDOT Designated PA Bicycle Route A) multiple times as it travels through Coraopolis Borough primarily via 4th and 5th Avenue (9,000-12,000 AADT). Downtown has a transit-oriented framework of “gridded” streets with pedestrian-oriented land uses and transit service. The Port Authority Thorn Run ‘Park and Ride Lot’ will be connected to the Trail and will serve as a trailhead, all buses have bike racks, and there is service to the Pittsburgh International Airport. The project context is walkable, and the Trail will provide the missing cohesive multi-modal spine to ensure connectivity with the Ohio River. There are millions of dollars in pending regional recreational facilities located at each end of the proposed project corridor that are currently cut-off from the majority of the population. The Trail project will resolve the bike/ped needs.

2.) *Reduce the impacts of transportation on the environment.* The project improves air-quality through the promotion of alternative forms of transportation (bicycle/ped./transit), modal-choice and integrates innovative design concepts which directly improve environmental quality. Much of the Coraopolis’s sewage system consists of combined sewer outfalls. The proposed design would reduce impervious surfaces and runoff through improved site-specific infiltration techniques such as bio-swales in streetscaping.

3.) *Reduce the need for costly future investments in public infrastructure.* The coalition of Ohio River Communities in the ORTC has sought to address the demise of major industrial businesses and clean-up brownfields properties. As the result of recent regional comprehensive planning efforts by both counties and the MPO, a new level of multi-municipal planning has occurred which supports the Ohio River Trail as a model of corridor-wide “green” transportation infrastructure that support economic development strategies, especially on brownfields; advancing actual development projects and improving environmental quality and public access to and along the Ohio River. Communities will then be connected together through sustainable transportation networks which promote transportation choices.

4.) *Provide efficient access to jobs, services, and centers of trade.* The goal of all of the communities within the Ohio River Corridor is to create a more livable environment that expands the economic potential for each and a healthy, high quality-of-life for their residents. The river is the biggest asset, and the trail will capitalize on it. The regional approach develops sound and sustainable transportation infrastructure linked to site-specific economic development. This project will achieve real and measureable environmental, economic and quality-of-life improvements in the project area, as well as establishing a model transportation project for all of the other 26 ORTC communities within the Ohio River Corridor.

5.) *Examine community development patterns and identify strategies to encourage private sector development that achieves the purposes identified in (1) through (4).* Due to abandoned industrial riverfront brownfield areas, there are many opportunities for appropriate redevelopment. The U.S. EPA funded study shows that if adequate transportation access can be provided many brownfields sites are ripe for redevelopment and therefore environmental clean-up and smart growth/infill.

If applicable, describe how the project meets all of the priority consideration criteria. 1) Project is in line with state and regional plans. The “2040 Transportation and Development Plan for Southwestern PA” calls for the provision of transportation options and the connection of existing regional trail assets to additional communities through the establishment of expanded trail networks. The “PA Statewide Outdoor Recreation Plan (2009-2013)” recommends the promotion of green and walkable communities. 2.) Project integrates Green Corridor program along the roadway and alleyways. 3.) Project reduces air pollution by encouraging bike/ped modes of transportation. 4.) Project includes public/private/nontraditional partners such as National Heritage Area and downtown business development entities. 5.) Project encourages private sector investments through business development along the trail corridor.

Describe how the project meets the project selection criteria **Livability** - improved and safer walkable and bikeable communities, reduced traffic on certain roadways, and design of certain complete streets, improved crosswalks and signals. **State of Good Repair** - improvements will be made on existing streets to accommodate bike/ped. **Safety** - Bike/ped signs, signals, and crosswalks will be designed into the project. **Expeditious Completion of Project** - will be completed within one year of Notice to Proceed. State Priorities - **Leveraging of private or other public funding** - Applications for PA-DCNR C2P2 planning grant will be completed by April 2012, for use as the cash match. Also, Allegheny County and municipalities will be tapped for buy-in. **Amount of TCSP funding** - This is a scalable project, and if the full amount requested cannot be funded by TCSP, the limits of work can be decreased to a smaller project, and the applicant could accept as little as \$100,000 total project, with \$80,000 TCSP and \$20,000 local match.

National Distribution - This project is part of the Greater Pittsburgh Area, and has very urban segments, but also has lower density neighborhoods along the route, especially due to loss of population and abandoned industrial sites along the river.

Discuss the project schedule, commitment of public and private funding, and any other TCSP or other Federal funding being used for the project.

Schedule/Timeline: September 2012 project funds are obligated. October 2012 Steering Committee is formalized. January 2013 RFP's are received and consultant selected. January 2014 Project is complete. **Funding:** While we currently do not have the cash in hand, nor written commitment of in-kind or cash, we are confident that the project match will be met in a timely way. Partners are working closely with PA-DCNR and will apply for their C2P2 grant which is due April 2012. The EPA Brownfields project ensures federal agency involvement and assistance. Project partners, including NPS Rivers & Trails Program, are proceeding with identifying sources of matching funds. To be honest, we had a very short turn-around on preparing this application, and have this goal of fundraising. We have strong support as indicated by the Letters of Support.

Part D. Project Eligibility

- a. Is the project located on a Federal-aid highway? (List the functional class(es) of the facility(ies) to be improved)*

Yes, some of the on-road portion of the trail uses PA State Route 51, as 'share the road'.

- b. If the project is not located on a Federal-aid highway, how do you consider the project eligible for assistance under Title 23 or Chapter 53 of Title 49, United States Code? (i.e., list program(s) and describe how the project meets the statutory eligibility criteria for that program.)*

The off-road portions of the trail are bike/ped path and alternative transportation routes, and meet the eligibility criteria.

- c. Is the project a corridor preservation activity necessary to implement transit-oriented development plans, traffic calming measures, or other coordinated transportation, community, and system preservation practices?*

This Phase I project supports alternative modes of transportation, and will link transit-oriented centers and communities of Coraopolis, Moon Township, and Sewickley, as well as Pittsburgh and other trail-linked communities in the larger vision.